

ImageXposed

Digital Image Authenticity Verification System

Project Team

Muhammad Ahmad Abbas 24I-3058

Hassan Amir 24I-0556

Tahira Tareef 24I-0721

Course Instructor

Mr. Majid Hussain



Department of Computer Science

National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences

Islamabad, Pakistan

1. Project Overview

ImageXposed is a comprehensive desktop-based application designed to address the growing challenges of digital media verification. The system is developed using Java, utilizing Swing or JavaFX for the graphical user interface, and is supported by a robust SQL or Oracle database backend. The primary function of the system is to assist users in determining whether a digital image retains its original integrity or has been subjected to editing and manipulation. To achieve this, the application analyzes uploaded images through a multi-faceted approach, extracting critical metadata details, generating unique hash values for integrity verification, and applying Error Level Analysis (ELA) to identify and highlight suspicious areas within the file structure.

The system is designed to visually display the image alongside its technical details, clearly marking potentially manipulated regions to ensure the data is easily understandable for the user. The target audience for this software includes students, journalists, researchers, and various organizations that require a dependable method to verify the authenticity of digital images. This project falls squarely within the domain of Digital Media Forensics and Cybersecurity, providing a necessary tool for truth verification in the digital age.

2. Motivation

In the modern digital landscape, image editing tools have become ubiquitous and easily accessible, allowing individuals to manipulate visual content with high precision. This accessibility makes it simple to alter images without leaving noticeable visual traces, creating a significant challenge for authenticity. Such edited images are frequently utilized to spread misinformation, facilitate fraud, or misrepresent factual events, leading to a degradation of trust in digital media. While there are existing verification tools available, many suffer from significant limitations; they are often web-based, requiring internet connectivity, are expensive paid services, or are too technical for the average user to operate effectively.

Consequently, there is a strong and urgent need for a simple, offline, and user-friendly system that empowers users to verify image authenticity without necessitating advanced technical knowledge or forensic training. ImageXposed aims to bridge this gap by providing a reliable, understandable, and accessible solution. The motivation behind this project is to help users detect possible tampering effectively, thereby restoring and building trust in the digital media ecosystem.

3. Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to design and develop a highly user-friendly desktop Graphical User Interface (GUI) using Java Swing or JavaFX, ensuring accessibility for all user types. A core technical objective is the implementation of Error Level Analysis (ELA), a forensic method used for detecting possible image manipulation by analyzing compression artifacts. Furthermore, the system aims to extract and display comprehensive image metadata, including camera make and model information as well as details regarding any editing software that may have been used on the file.

To ensure data integrity, the system will generate cryptographic MD5 and SHA-256 hash values, allowing for precise verification of the image file. The application is also designed to visually highlight suspicious areas within an image, making the interpretation of forensic data easier for non-experts. Additionally, the project includes the implementation of secure storage for scan history using an SQL or Oracle database, ensuring that past verifications can be reviewed. The final objectives are to generate structured forensic reports for user reference and to ensure the overall system accuracy, usability, and data security throughout the verification process.

4. Expected Outcomes

Upon completion, the project is expected to deliver a fully functional desktop-based image authenticity verification system. The key outcome will be the accurate detection of potential image manipulation through the successful implementation of Error Level Analysis (ELA). Users will benefit from a clear and organized display of metadata and cryptographic hash values, providing immediate insight into the file's history. A significant visual outcome will be the representation of suspicious regions within analyzed images, allowing users to pinpoint exactly where alterations may have occurred.

The system will also feature secure and reliable database integration, facilitating the efficient storage and retrieval of scan records. This will result in vastly improved efficiency compared to traditional, manual image verification methods. Ultimately, the project will result in a simple, intuitive, and easy-to-use interface that is suitable for both technical experts and non-technical users alike, democratizing access to forensic tools.

5. Project Scope

The scope of this project is strictly defined to ensure a focused and effective development process. The in-scope functionalities include the ability to upload and display images within the desktop environment. The core analytical capabilities will cover the implementation of Error Level Analysis (ELA), the extraction and presentation of metadata, and the generation of MD5 and SHA-256 hash values. The project will also include the development of a database system for scan history storage and retrieval using SQL or Oracle, along with basic user authentication if required by the use case. Furthermore, the system will support the generation and export of forensic reports.

Conversely, certain elements are explicitly out-of-scope for this iteration of the project. This includes the detection of deepfakes, video, or audio manipulation. The project will not incorporate AI-based advanced machine learning models, nor will it involve web-based or cloud deployment. Mobile application development and real-time social media monitoring are also excluded from the current scope. Future enhancements may include AI-assisted detection techniques and online verification features, but these are not part of the current proposal.

6. Tools and Technologies

The development of ImageXposed will rely on a robust set of tools and technologies. The frontend will be constructed using Java, specifically utilizing Java Swing or JavaFX to create the Graphical User Interface. The backend infrastructure will be supported by an SQL or Oracle Database, with JDBC employed to manage database connectivity.

For the development environment, the project will utilize standard Integrated Development Environments (IDEs) such as NetBeans, IntelliJ IDEA, or Eclipse. Specific libraries will be integrated to handle core functionalities, including metadata-extractor for retrieving image details and iText or Apache PDFBox for generating PDF forensic reports. Finally, all source code and project versions will be managed and tracked using Git for version control.